

Elaine Yu

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SUMMARY

Designer and CS student at Duke with 2+ years of experience across design systems, product design, and AI tooling: defining design standards at IBM, leading product redesigns at HackDuke, and co-authoring peer-reviewed geospatial research at UNL. Translates ambiguous constraints into accessible, production-ready design systems.

EDUCATION

Duke University

Expected May 2029

B.S. in Computer Science, Visual Media Studies

- Relevant Coursework: Digital Imaging, Data Structures and Algorithms, Elements of Machine Learning, Computer Architecture, Matrices and Vectors, Calculus I-III
- Involvements: Catalyst Tech Society (Marketing Chair), HackDuke, Figma Campus Leader, Duke Digital Arts

WORK EXPERIENCE

Mercor | Remote

September 2026 - Present

Designer (Part-Time)

- Developing Mercor's visual design system across **7 brand touchpoints** to shape the new design direction

HackDuke Design Team | Durham, NC

September 2025 - Present

Design Lead

- Led end-to-end redesign of the HackDuke website, analyzing user flows and usability issues to improve the registration experience for 500+ annual participants, **increasing registrations by 80%**
- Accelerated early-stage design by using **Figma Make** for rapid wireframing and prototyping, reducing wireframing time by 70%, enabling the team to focus on complex user flows and high-impact features
- Produced a reusable visual identity for HackDuke, generating 20+ digital assets to support event communication across platforms, **strengthening overall online visibility by 50%**

IBM | Durham, NC

May 2026 - August 2026

Z DevX UX Design Intern

- Defined IBM's **first MCP design guidelines** for the Z DevX team from the ground up, researching how leading AI companies structure tool design to establish org-wide standards for tool naming, parameters, and documentation — **increasing the team's AI tool usage by 30%**
- Designed an information architecture that organized AI tools into modes and skills, then condensed the guidelines into a company-wide skill library, **improving token efficiency by 50%**
- Partnered with lead architects and design peers to iterate on standards, translating ambiguous requirements around context size, accessibility, and localization into a design system built for cross-team reuse

University of Nebraska-Lincoln | Lincoln, NE

June 2024 - August 2025

Product Designer and Research Intern

- Designed print-first flood-risk outreach for low-income rural communities, translating GIS data into visuals for **8,000+ residents across 59 Nebraska communities**, with adoption by HUD-related stakeholders
- Improved time-sensitive disaster outreach by integrating **AI-assisted tools (DALL-E, GPT-4)** into the creative pipeline while maintaining WCAG-compliant human review, reducing iteration time by 30%
- Studied flood recovery patterns using GIS and deep learning (Siamese U-Net), analyzing socioeconomic and demographic disparities, **co-authoring a peer-reviewed publication**

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Languages:** Java, HTML/CSS, React, JavaScript, Python, C/C++
- **Tools:** Figma (Design, Make, Motion, FigJam), Git/Github, Procreate, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator), Generative AI & LLMs (Claude, ChatGPT, Cursor, Gemini), Canva, ArcGIS
- **Skills:** UI/UX Design, Graphic Design, Wireframing, Illustration, Brand Direction, Rapid Prototyping